34 bài mẫu IELTS Writing Task 2 — Work & Careers

Từ và cụm quan trọng được tô màu; cuối mỗi bài là các cụm cần nhớ kèm nghĩa. Điểm do AI chấm, chỉ để tham khảo.

Cụm từ | Từ đồng nghĩa | Từ nối | Khung câu | Câu mang ý | Câu ví dụ

Agree / Disagree

#27 Agree / Disagree · 263 từ · AI 7.5

Many people say that unemployment is a growing problem in their country. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Newspapers often report factory closures and long queues of jobseekers, and many people say that unemployment is a growing problem in their country. I agree to a large extent, since automation and economic uncertainty are removing jobs, although the situation differs between countries and periods.

To begin with, unemployment is a serious problem where skills do not match available jobs. Automation, economic slowdowns and a gap between education and employer needs leave many people without work, especially the young. A graduate who applies for hundreds of positions and receives no reply, for example, can lose confidence and fall into long-term unemployment. Factories that install robots need fewer workers, and companies that move production abroad close local plants, which leaves whole towns without a major employer. Older workers who lose their jobs often find it very difficult to be hired again.

Furthermore, the consequences of unemployment are costly for individuals and for society. Families lose income, health problems and crime may increase, and governments pay more in benefits while collecting less in taxes. However, the trend is not the same everywhere, and some countries have very low rates. Retraining programmes, support for new businesses and better links between schools and employers can reduce the problem. Unemployment is therefore not an unavoidable fate, but it demands active policies, particularly in regions that depend on a single industry, and a failure to act risks permanent damage to communities.

In conclusion, I agree that unemployment is a growing problem in many countries, but its size depends on policy, so governments should invest in skills and job creation.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **long queues of jobseekers** — hàng dài người tìm việc
- **unemployment is a growing problem** — thất nghiệp là vấn đề ngày càng lớn
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **economic uncertainty** — bất ổn kinh tế
- **skills do not match available jobs** — kỹ năng không khớp với việc làm sẵn có
- **a gap between education and employer needs** — khoảng cách giữa giáo dục và nhu cầu nhà tuyển dụng
- **applies for hundreds of positions** — nộp đơn vào hàng trăm vị trí
- **long-term unemployment** — thất nghiệp dài hạn
- **install robots** — lắp đặt robot
- **move production abroad** — chuyển sản xuất ra nước ngoài
- **a major employer** — nhà tuyển dụng lớn
- **Older workers** — người lao động lớn tuổi
- **pay more in benefits while collecting less in taxes** — chi nhiều trợ cấp hơn trong khi thu ít thuế hơn
- **Retraining programmes** — chương trình đào tạo lại
- **links between schools and employers** — mối liên kết giữa trường học và nhà tuyển dụng
- **active policies** — chính sách chủ động
- **depend on a single industry** — phụ thuộc vào một ngành duy nhất
- **permanent damage to communities** — tổn hại lâu dài cho cộng đồng
- **job creation** — tạo việc làm

#74 Agree / Disagree · 284 từ · AI 7.0

Many people think that freelancing has improved people's lives. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

More and more professionals work as freelancers, taking projects from several clients instead of holding a permanent job, and many people say that this has improved lives. I agree to some extent, since freelancing gives independence, although it removes security.

To begin with, freelancing improves life for those who value independence. Freelancers choose clients, hours and place, and can earn more than employees. A graphic designer who works from a café and accepts only interesting projects, for example, controls her own time and develops a wide range of skills. Parents and carers can fit work around family needs, and people in rural areas can sell services worldwide through the internet. Many freelancers say that they feel more motivated, since their income depends directly on the quality of their work. Digital platforms have also made it much easier to find clients and to receive payment from abroad, which has widened the range of people who can work independently.

However, freelancing also removes security. Income is uneven, and freelancers receive no sick pay or pension and must find work constantly. A month without clients, or an illness, can cause a financial crisis, and obtaining a loan or a rented home is harder without a regular salary. Some people are forced into freelance work because employers refuse to hire permanent staff, so their independence is only apparent. Moreover, clients sometimes pay late or very low rates. Freelancing therefore suits skilled and confident workers rather than everyone, and governments should help by offering fair payment rules and access to insurance.

In conclusion, I agree that freelancing has improved life for many people, but only for those who can manage uncertainty, and protection should be strengthened for the rest.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **work as freelancers** — làm việc như người làm tự do
- **instead of holding a permanent job** — thay vì giữ công việc cố định
- **freelancing improves life** — làm tự do cải thiện cuộc sống
- **value independence** — coi trọng sự độc lập
- **choose clients, hours and place** — chọn khách hàng, giờ giấc và địa điểm
- **accepts only interesting projects** — chỉ nhận những dự án thú vị
- **controls her own time** — kiểm soát thời gian của mình
- **a wide range of skills** — nhiều loại kỹ năng
- **fit work around family needs** — sắp xếp công việc quanh nhu cầu gia đình
- **sell services worldwide** — bán dịch vụ trên toàn thế giới
- **more motivated** — có động lực hơn
- **independently** — một cách độc lập
- **Income is uneven** — thu nhập thất thường
- **no sick pay or pension** — không có tiền ốm đau hay lương hưu
- **a financial crisis** — khủng hoảng tài chính
- **a regular salary** — mức lương đều đặn
- **forced into freelance work** — bị buộc phải làm tự do
- **pay late or very low rates** — trả muộn hoặc với mức rất thấp
- **fair payment rules and access to insurance** — quy tắc thanh toán công bằng và khả năng tiếp cận bảo hiểm

#87 Agree / Disagree · 272 từ · AI 7.0

Many people say that technology increases productivity. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

From spreadsheets to robots, tools have changed the way people work, and many people say that technology increases productivity. I agree with this view, since modern tools allow workers to do more in less time, although distractions can reduce the gain.

To begin with, technology raises productivity by speeding up tasks and communication. Software, machines and data tools let workers do more in less time. A warehouse that uses scanners and automated conveyor belts, for example, can process thousands of parcels per day with a small team, where once many people were required. Email and video calls allow colleagues in different countries to cooperate instantly, and cloud systems let them share documents without delay. In agriculture, modern machines and sensors help a single farmer to manage land that previously needed dozens of labourers, and output per worker has grown in most industries.

Furthermore, technology improves accuracy and frees people for more valuable work. Computers calculate, record and check data without tiredness, and routine administration can be automated. However, the gain is not automatic. Notifications, social media and constant messages distract staff, and some employees need long training before they use new systems efficiently. Poorly chosen software can even slow work, for example when staff must enter the same data into several incompatible systems. Companies therefore need to select tools carefully, to train staff and to set rules about their use. When these conditions are met, productivity rises significantly, which allows higher wages or shorter working hours.

In conclusion, I agree that technology increases productivity, because it speeds up work and reduces errors, but it should be introduced with proper training and management.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **From spreadsheets to robots** — từ bảng tính đến robot
- **technology increases productivity** — công nghệ làm tăng năng suất
- **do more in less time** — làm được nhiều hơn trong ít thời gian hơn
- **raises productivity** — nâng năng suất
- **speeding up tasks and communication** — đẩy nhanh công việc và giao tiếp
- **scanners and automated conveyor belts** — máy quét và băng chuyền tự động
- **process thousands of parcels per day** — xử lý hàng nghìn bưu kiện mỗi ngày
- **a small team** — một nhóm nhỏ
- **Email and video calls** — email và cuộc gọi video
- **cooperate instantly** — hợp tác ngay lập tức
- **cloud systems** — hệ thống đám mây
- **machines and sensors** — máy móc và cảm biến
- **dozens of labourers** — hàng chục công nhân
- **output per worker** — sản lượng trên mỗi lao động
- **improves accuracy** — cải thiện độ chính xác
- **routine administration can be automated** — công việc hành chính thường nhật có thể được tự động hoá
- **not automatic** — không tự động
- **Notifications, social media and constant messages distract staff** — thông báo, mạng xã hội và tin nhắn liên tục làm nhân viên xao nhãng
- **long training** — đào tạo dài
- **Poorly chosen software** — phần mềm được chọn kém
- **set rules about their use** — đặt quy tắc về việc sử dụng
- **productivity rises** — năng suất tăng
- **higher wages or shorter working hours** — lương cao hơn hoặc giờ làm ngắn hơn

#396 Agree / Disagree · 263 từ · AI 7.0

Many people think that technology reduces manual labour jobs. Do you agree? Explain with examples.

Assembly lines, harvesters and automated warehouses have replaced many tasks once done by hand, and many people think that technology reduces manual labour jobs. I agree to a large extent, although not all manual work will disappear.

To begin with, technology removes many repetitive manual jobs. Machines replace repetitive factory and farm work, because they are faster, cheaper and do not tire. A modern harvester, for example, can do in an hour what once needed dozens of labourers in a day, and a robot arm can pack boxes without a break. Ports use automated cranes, mines use remote-controlled vehicles, and supermarkets are introducing self-service tills. As the cost of machines falls and their abilities improve, more tasks become suitable for automation, and the number of workers in these sectors has already fallen sharply in many countries.

However, technology does not remove all manual work. Skilled trades such as plumbing, building and care need adaptable hands and judgement that machines cannot yet provide. A plumber who repairs an old pipe in a cramped space, for example, faces a different problem every time. New jobs also appear in programming, maintenance and repair of machines, which means that manual work changes in nature rather than vanishing. The challenge is therefore to prepare workers for this change through training, so that those displaced from factories and farms can move to growing fields. Governments and employers share responsibility for providing this support.

In conclusion, I agree that technology reduces manual labour jobs, particularly routine ones, but some skilled manual work will remain, and workers need retraining to adapt.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Assembly lines, harvesters and automated warehouses** — dây chuyền lắp ráp, máy gặt và kho tự động
- **technology reduces manual labour jobs** — công nghệ làm giảm việc lao động chân tay
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **disappear** — biến mất
- **repetitive manual jobs** — công việc chân tay lặp đi lặp lại
- **repetitive factory and farm work** — công việc lặp lại ở nhà máy và trang trại
- **faster, cheaper and do not tire** — nhanh hơn, rẻ hơn và không biết mệt
- **a modern harvester** — một chiếc máy gặt hiện đại
- **dozens of labourers** — hàng chục công nhân
- **a robot arm can pack boxes** — một cánh tay robot có thể đóng gói hộp
- **automated cranes** — cần cẩu tự động
- **remote-controlled vehicles** — phương tiện điều khiển từ xa
- **self-service tills** — quầy tự thanh toán
- **fallen sharply** — giảm mạnh
- **Skilled trades such as plumbing, building and care** — các nghề có tay nghề như sửa ống nước, xây dựng và chăm sóc
- **adaptable hands and judgement** — đôi tay linh hoạt và khả năng phán đoán
- **repairs an old pipe in a cramped space** — sửa một ống nước cũ ở chỗ chật hẹp
- **programming, maintenance and repair of machines** — lập trình, bảo trì và sửa chữa máy móc
- **changes in nature rather than vanishing** — thay đổi bản chất chứ không biến mất
- **displaced from factories and farms** — bị mất việc ở nhà máy và nông trại
- **retraining** — đào tạo lại

#403 Agree / Disagree · 267 từ · AI 7.5

Some people say that paid internships exploit young workers. Do you agree or disagree?

Many students and graduates accept internships in which they receive little money, and some people say that paid internships exploit young workers. I disagree to a large extent, since interns gain valuable experience, although unfair practices should be controlled.

To begin with, paid internships are not exploitation when they teach real skills. Interns gain experience and contacts that help their careers. A graduate who spends six months in a newspaper office, for example, learns how to write for deadlines and meets editors who may later offer her a job. Employers must spend time training and supervising interns, so that the arrangement benefits both sides, and the small payment recognises the effort of the intern. Without internships, many young people would find it almost impossible to obtain a first position, since most employers ask for experience that they cannot yet have.

However, some firms do use interns as cheap labour with little training, so rules on pay, hours and tasks are needed. A company that asks interns to make coffee and copy documents for a year, for example, is plainly using them to save the cost of staff. Unpaid or very low-paid placements also favour wealthy families, who can support their children, and exclude talented young people from poorer homes. Governments should therefore require at least a minimum wage, limit the length of placements and check that the work involves real learning. Universities can also monitor the quality of the posts that they recommend.

In conclusion, I disagree that paid internships exploit young workers, provided that they are fairly regulated, because good internships benefit both interns and employers.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **accept internships** — chấp nhận thực tập
- **paid internships exploit young workers** — thực tập có lương bóc lột lao động trẻ
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **gain valuable experience** — có được kinh nghiệm quý giá
- **controlled** — được kiểm soát
- **teach real skills** — dạy kỹ năng thực sự
- **experience and contacts that help their careers** — kinh nghiệm và mối quan hệ giúp ích sự nghiệp
- **write for deadlines** — viết theo thời hạn
- **meets editors** — gặp các biên tập viên
- **training and supervising interns** — đào tạo và giám sát thực tập sinh
- **recognises the effort of the intern** — ghi nhận nỗ lực của thực tập sinh
- **a first position** — vị trí đầu tiên
- **cheap labour with little training** — lao động rẻ với ít đào tạo
- **make coffee and copy documents** — pha cà phê và photo tài liệu
- **save the cost of staff** — tiết kiệm chi phí nhân viên
- **favour wealthy families** — thiên vị các gia đình giàu có
- **talented young people from poorer homes** — người trẻ tài năng từ gia đình nghèo hơn
- **a minimum wage** — mức lương tối thiểu
- **limit the length of placements** — giới hạn thời gian thực tập
- **real learning** — việc học thực sự
- **fairly regulated** — được quản lý công bằng

#449 Agree / Disagree · 276 từ · AI 7.0

Many people say that open-plan offices harm productivity. Do you agree or disagree? Give reasons and examples.

Many modern offices have removed walls and private rooms so that dozens of employees share one large space, and many people say that open-plan offices harm productivity. I agree to a large extent, since noise and interruptions make concentration hard, although they have some advantages.

To begin with, open-plan offices harm concentration. Noise and interruptions make deep work hard and reduce privacy, so employees often spend time wearing headphones or leave the desk to find quiet. An analyst who is writing a complex report, for example, loses focus each time a colleague takes a phone call or stops to chat. Studies show that people need many minutes to regain concentration after an interruption, which means that several short disturbances can waste a large part of the day. Open spaces also increase the spread of colds, and some staff feel stressed by being watched constantly, which reduces both wellbeing and output.

However, open-plan offices have some advantages that explain their popularity. They cost less to build, make it easy to ask colleagues questions and encourage a friendly atmosphere in which ideas are shared. For tasks that depend on teamwork, such as brainstorming, they may help. Nevertheless, these benefits do not remove the need for quiet. Mixed layouts that combine shared areas for collaboration with quiet rooms, booths and the right to work at home on certain days work better. Employers should also set simple rules about noise and meetings, so that people can choose the space that suits their task.

In conclusion, I agree that open-plan offices harm productivity to a large extent, and companies should provide a variety of workspaces instead of a single large room.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **removed walls and private rooms** — bỏ tường và phòng riêng
- **open-plan offices harm productivity** — văn phòng mở làm hại năng suất
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **Noise and interruptions make deep work hard** — tiếng ồn và sự gián đoạn khiến làm việc sâu khó khăn
- **reduce privacy** — giảm sự riêng tư
- **wearing headphones** — đeo tai nghe
- **writing a complex report** — viết một báo cáo phức tạp
- **loses focus** — mất tập trung
- **takes a phone call** — nghe điện thoại
- **regain concentration after an interruption** — lấy lại sự tập trung sau gián đoạn
- **the spread of colds** — sự lây lan cảm lạnh
- **watched constantly** — bị theo dõi liên tục
- **cost less to build** — rẻ hơn khi xây dựng
- **ask colleagues questions** — hỏi đồng nghiệp
- **a friendly atmosphere in which ideas are shared** — bầu không khí thân thiện nơi ý tưởng được chia sẻ
- **brainstorming** — động não
- **Mixed layouts** — bố trí hỗn hợp
- **quiet rooms, booths** — phòng yên tĩnh, buồng riêng
- **simple rules about noise and meetings** — quy tắc đơn giản về tiếng ồn và cuộc họp
- **a variety of workspaces** — nhiều loại không gian làm việc

#463 Agree / Disagree · 285 từ · AI 7.0

Some people say that public holidays should be reduced to increase productivity. Do you agree or disagree?

Some politicians suggest that fewer days off would make the economy stronger, and some people say that public holidays should be reduced to increase productivity. I disagree with this view, since extra working days would harm wellbeing and bring little additional output.

To begin with, reducing public holidays would not raise productivity. Holidays let workers recover, spend time with family and support tourism and culture, while extra working days bring tired staff and little additional output. A worker who takes a day off before a long weekend, for example, usually returns refreshed and works faster. Research shows that productivity per hour falls as people work longer, so that countries with many holidays, such as some in northern Europe, are often among the most productive. Total output depends on the quality of work, not just the number of days.

Furthermore, public holidays have social and economic value. They allow families to celebrate festivals, remember history and maintain traditions, which creates a sense of community. Restaurants, hotels, transport companies and shops depend on holiday spending, so fewer days off could cost these industries more than the extra work gains. Tired and unhappy employees also take more sick leave and are more likely to quit. However, there is a case for flexibility, for instance by letting workers swap holidays for days that match their own beliefs. Rest is part of a productive economy, and the aim should be efficiency and not a longer calendar. Governments that want higher output would do better to invest in training, equipment and management than to cut the days on which people rest.

In conclusion, I disagree that public holidays should be reduced to increase productivity, because rest sustains both wellbeing and performance.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **fewer days off** — ít ngày nghỉ hơn
- **public holidays should be reduced** — ngày lễ nên được giảm bớt
- **wellbeing and bring little additional output** — sức khoẻ tinh thần và đem lại ít sản lượng thêm
- **let workers recover** — giúp người lao động hồi phục
- **support tourism and culture** — hỗ trợ du lịch và văn hoá
- **tired staff** — nhân viên mệt mỏi
- **takes a day off before a long weekend** — nghỉ một ngày trước kỳ nghỉ cuối tuần dài
- **returns refreshed** — trở lại với tinh thần sảng khoái
- **productivity per hour falls** — năng suất mỗi giờ giảm
- **northern Europe** — Bắc Âu
- **the quality of work** — chất lượng công việc
- **celebrate festivals, remember history** — tổ chức lễ hội, tưởng nhớ lịch sử
- **maintain traditions** — duy trì truyền thống
- **a sense of community** — cảm giác cộng đồng
- **holiday spending** — chi tiêu dịp lễ
- **sick leave** — nghỉ ốm
- **swap holidays** — hoán đổi ngày lễ
- **a productive economy** — một nền kinh tế năng suất

#468 Agree / Disagree · 268 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent do you agree or disagree that remote work reduces urban congestion?

When millions of people commute at the same hour, roads and trains become overcrowded, and some argue that remote work reduces urban congestion. I agree to a limited extent, since remote work reduces peak-hour traffic, but it does not remove it.

To begin with, remote work reduces peak-hour congestion. Fewer people commute at rush hour and emissions fall. A city in which a quarter of office workers stay at home on two days of the week, for example, will see much lighter traffic and less crowded trains on those days. During the pandemic, many cities recorded sharp drops in traffic, cleaner air and shorter journey times. Employers can also encourage staggered start times, which spread demand over a longer period. Roads that are less crowded save fuel and time for those who must still travel, such as delivery drivers and emergency services.

However, remote work does not solve congestion on its own. Some workers make other trips during the day, many jobs cannot be done at home and freed road space attracts other drivers. Traffic often returns to its previous level when more cars use the spaces left by those who stay at home. Cities that rely on remote work alone are also likely to see few changes at weekends or in school terms. It helps most as part of wider transport policy: better public transport, congestion charges, cycle lanes and city planning that places homes, shops and jobs close together are all needed.

In conclusion, remote work reduces urban congestion to a limited extent, and it should be combined with other measures to produce a lasting improvement.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **commute at the same hour** — đi làm cùng một giờ
- **overcrowded** — quá tải
- **urban congestion** — tắc nghẽn đô thị
- **to a limited extent** — ở mức độ hạn chế
- **remote work reduces peak-hour congestion** — làm việc từ xa giảm tắc nghẽn giờ cao điểm
- **Fewer people commute at rush hour** — ít người đi làm vào giờ cao điểm hơn
- **emissions fall** — khí thải giảm
- **stay at home on two days of the week** — ở nhà hai ngày trong tuần
- **lighter traffic and less crowded trains** — giao thông nhẹ hơn và tàu ít đông hơn
- **sharp drops in traffic, cleaner air** — giảm mạnh lưu lượng, không khí sạch hơn
- **staggered start times** — giờ bắt đầu so le
- **delivery drivers and emergency services** — tài xế giao hàng và dịch vụ khẩn cấp
- **congestion** — tắc nghẽn giao thông
- **Some workers make other trips** — một số người đi làm thực hiện các chuyến khác
- **freed road space attracts other drivers** — đường trống thu hút những tài xế khác
- **returns to its previous level** — trở lại mức trước đó
- **stay at home** — ở nhà
- **wider transport policy** — chính sách giao thông rộng hơn
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **congestion charges, cycle lanes** — phí tắc nghẽn, làn xe đạp
- **close together** — gần nhau
- **a lasting improvement** — sự cải thiện lâu dài

#483 Agree / Disagree · 278 từ · AI 7.0

Some people say that career switching is essential in modern economies. Do you agree or disagree?

A century ago, most people kept one occupation for a lifetime, but today many change careers more than once, and some people say that career switching is essential in modern economies. I agree with this view, since technology and globalisation make some jobs disappear and create others.

To begin with, career switching has become a necessary skill in changing economies. Technology and globalisation make some jobs disappear and create others, so workers who can retrain and move between fields stay employable. A typist whose work has been replaced by software, for example, may retrain as an administrator or a data analyst, while another who refuses to change may face long unemployment. Industries such as coal mining, printing and travel agencies have shrunk dramatically, whereas digital marketing and renewable energy have grown. Employees who keep learning can follow opportunities instead of being trapped in declining sectors. Young workers today may be expected to hold a dozen jobs in their lives.

Furthermore, changing careers can also bring personal benefits, such as greater satisfaction and higher pay. People who discover that their first choice does not suit them can find work that matches their talents. However, changing is costly and risky. It may mean a drop in income, years of study and uncertainty, and not everyone has the savings or confidence to begin again. Governments and employers can help by supporting adult education, funding, retraining and recognising skills gained in other jobs. When such help exists, switching becomes a realistic option instead of a gamble.

In conclusion, I agree that career switching is essential in modern economies, because it lets people adapt to change, but it needs support from public policy.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **change careers more than once** — đổi nghề nhiều hơn một lần
- **career switching is essential** — đổi nghề là thiết yếu
- **Technology and globalisation** — công nghệ và toàn cầu hoá
- **disappear** — biến mất
- **retrain and move between fields** — đào tạo lại và chuyển giữa các lĩnh vực
- **stay employable** — giữ khả năng có việc làm
- **replaced by software** — bị phần mềm thay thế
- **retrain as an administrator or a data analyst** — đào tạo lại thành nhân viên hành chính hoặc nhà phân tích dữ liệu
- **long unemployment** — thất nghiệp dài
- **coal mining, printing and travel agencies** — khai thác than, in ấn và đại lý du lịch
- **digital marketing and renewable energy** — tiếp thị số và năng lượng tái tạo
- **trapped in declining sectors** — mắc kẹt trong những ngành suy giảm
- **a dozen jobs** — cả chục công việc
- **greater satisfaction and higher pay** — sự hài lòng cao hơn và lương cao hơn
- **costly and risky** — tốn kém và rủi ro
- **a drop in income** — giảm thu nhập
- **adult education** — giáo dục người lớn
- **retraining** — đào tạo lại
- **recognising skills gained in other jobs** — công nhận kỹ năng có được từ công việc khác
- **a realistic option instead of a gamble** — lựa chọn thực tế thay vì canh bạc

Advantages / Disadvantages

#48 Advantages / Disadvantages · 271 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of remote working.

Since 2020, millions of employees have worked from home for part or all of the week, and the question is whether remote working is a good development. This essay will discuss its advantages and disadvantages before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, remote work saves time and widens opportunity. Workers avoid commuting and can live in cheaper areas, and firms can recruit from a wider pool of talent. A parent who works from home, for example, can take children to school and still complete a full day. Employees often report greater satisfaction because they control their schedule, and companies can reduce spending on office space. Many studies also show that people who work quietly at home complete focused tasks faster, and fewer commuters means less traffic and pollution.

On the negative side, remote work can isolate staff and weaken teamwork. Loneliness, weaker collaboration and blurred limits between work and home may reduce wellbeing and creativity. Newcomers find it harder to learn from colleagues, and managers struggle to monitor progress and to build a shared culture. Not all jobs can be done remotely, which creates inequality between office staff and those in shops and factories. Some people also lack a quiet space at home, or find that they work longer hours because they can never leave the office. Hybrid arrangements, in which employees attend the workplace for part of the week, often combine the benefits of both patterns.

In conclusion, remote work offers flexibility but carries social costs. On balance, I believe that its advantages outweigh its disadvantages when it is organised in a hybrid form with regular face-to-face contact.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **worked from home for part or all of the week** — làm việc tại nhà một phần hoặc cả tuần
- **remote working** — làm việc từ xa
- **saves time and widens opportunity** — tiết kiệm thời gian và mở rộng cơ hội
- **Workers avoid commuting** — người lao động tránh phải đi lại
- **recruit from a wider pool of talent** — tuyển dụng từ nguồn nhân tài rộng hơn
- **control their schedule** — kiểm soát lịch làm việc
- **reduce spending on office space** — giảm chi cho không gian văn phòng
- **focused tasks** — công việc cần tập trung
- **less traffic and pollution** — ít kẹt xe và ô nhiễm hơn
- **isolate staff and weaken teamwork** — cô lập nhân viên và làm yếu tinh thần đồng đội
- **blurred limits between work and home** — ranh giới mờ giữa công việc và gia đình
- **learn from colleagues** — học hỏi từ đồng nghiệp
- **monitor progress** — theo dõi tiến độ
- **a shared culture** — văn hoá chung
- **inequality between office staff** — bất bình đẳng giữa nhân viên văn phòng
- **Hybrid arrangements** — mô hình kết hợp
- **social costs** — chi phí xã hội
- **regular face-to-face contact** — tiếp xúc trực tiếp thường xuyên

#79 Advantages / Disadvantages · 267 từ · AI 7.0

Do the advantages of longer working hours outweigh the disadvantages? Give reasons and examples.

In many economies, employees are asked to work overtime, and some countries are considering a longer standard working week, so the question is whether the advantages of longer working hours outweigh the disadvantages. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, longer hours can raise output and income. Workers who stay later earn extra pay, and firms can finish projects on time and serve customers for longer. A factory that adds a second shift, for example, can fill urgent orders and offer more jobs. In competitive industries, long hours may help a company to survive, and some employees enjoy the chance to progress faster by showing dedication. Governments sometimes argue that a longer week increases national output and tax revenue.

On the negative side, longer hours carry heavy human costs. Extra hours bring more pay and production, but tired workers make errors, suffer stress and illness, and have little time for family, so productivity per hour falls. Studies show that people who work very long weeks may be less productive than those on shorter schedules, and they are more likely to suffer heart disease and depression. Relationships, parenting and leisure suffer, which affects wider society, and employers lose staff through burnout. Shorter, focused hours are often more efficient, and several countries with short working weeks are among the most productive in the world.

In conclusion, longer working hours give limited benefits for a short period. On balance, I believe that the disadvantages outweigh the advantages, because the damage to health and family life is greater than the gain in output.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **work overtime** — làm thêm giờ
- **a longer standard working week** — tuần làm việc tiêu chuẩn dài hơn
- **longer working hours** — giờ làm việc dài hơn
- **raise output and income** — tăng sản lượng và thu nhập
- **earn extra pay** — kiếm thêm tiền lương
- **finish projects on time** — hoàn thành dự án đúng hạn
- **adds a second shift** — thêm một ca làm việc thứ hai
- **fill urgent orders** — đáp ứng đơn hàng gấp
- **national output and tax revenue** — sản lượng quốc gia và nguồn thu thuế
- **heavy human costs** — cái giá nặng nề về con người
- **make errors, suffer stress and illness** — mắc lỗi, bị căng thẳng và bệnh tật
- **productivity per hour falls** — năng suất mỗi giờ giảm
- **heart disease and depression** — bệnh tim và trầm cảm
- **Relationships, parenting and leisure suffer** — các mối quan hệ, việc nuôi dạy con và giải trí bị ảnh hưởng
- **lose staff through burnout** — mất nhân viên vì kiệt sức
- **Shorter, focused hours** — giờ làm ngắn và tập trung
- **among the most productive in the world** — nằm trong số những nước có năng suất cao nhất thế giới

#168 Advantages / Disadvantages · 268 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of working from home for families.

Since the pandemic, many parents have worked at home while children study or play nearby, and this essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of working from home for families before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, working from home gives families time and flexibility. Parents save travel time, can meet children after school and share chores. A father who finishes work at the kitchen table, for example, can cook dinner with his children instead of arriving home exhausted at eight. Parents are also nearby if a child falls ill, and mothers in particular can stay in their careers instead of leaving them for childcare. Families may save money on transport, lunches and childcare, and children see how their parents work, which can be educational. The relaxed atmosphere reduces the stress of the morning rush.

On the negative side, working from home can blur work and home life. Interruptions, small homes and the pressure to be always available can raise stress. A parent who attends an online meeting while a toddler cries, for example, may feel that she is failing both as an employee and as a mother. Without a separate workspace, work spreads into evenings and weekends, and partners may argue about who should supervise the children. Isolation from colleagues can also reduce motivation. Nevertheless, these problems can be reduced by keeping a regular schedule, creating a quiet corner for work and agreeing on rules with the family.

In conclusion, working from home brings real benefits to families, although it demands discipline. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the disadvantages for most households.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **worked at home while children study or play nearby** — làm việc ở nhà trong khi con học hay chơi gần đó
- **working from home for families** — làm việc tại nhà đối với các gia đình
- **time and flexibility** — thời gian và sự linh hoạt
- **Parents save travel time** — cha mẹ tiết kiệm thời gian đi lại
- **share chores** — chia sẻ việc nhà
- **finishes work at the kitchen table** — làm xong việc ở bàn bếp
- **cook dinner with his children** — nấu bữa tối cùng các con
- **arriving home exhausted** — về nhà trong tình trạng kiệt sức
- **stay in their careers** — giữ lại sự nghiệp
- **save money on transport, lunches and childcare** — tiết kiệm tiền đi lại, bữa trưa và giữ trẻ
- **the stress of the morning rush** — áp lực của buổi sáng vội vã
- **blur work and home life** — làm mờ ranh giới công việc và đời sống gia đình
- **Interruptions, small homes** — sự gián đoạn, nhà nhỏ
- **always available** — luôn sẵn sàng
- **a toddler cries** — đứa trẻ mới biết đi khóc
- **a separate workspace** — không gian làm việc riêng
- **work spreads into evenings and weekends** — công việc lấn sang buổi tối và cuối tuần
- **a quiet corner for work** — một góc yên tĩnh để làm việc
- **agreeing on rules** — thống nhất các quy tắc

#219 Advantages / Disadvantages · 270 từ · AI 7.0

Do the advantages of work automation outweigh the disadvantages? Give reasons and examples.

Self-service tills, robot arms and automated warehouses are replacing human tasks in many industries, and the question is whether the advantages of work automation outweigh the disadvantages. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, automation raises efficiency and safety. Machines work faster, make fewer errors and take over dangerous tasks. A car factory that uses robots to weld and paint, for example, produces vehicles of consistent quality while workers avoid fumes and heavy lifting. Automated systems can work day and night without rest, which lowers costs and prices for consumers. Companies also gain the chance to deploy their human staff on more interesting tasks such as design, supervision and customer care. In mining and chemical industries, machines can enter places that would be fatal to people.

On the negative side, automation threatens jobs. Workers in routine roles lose employment, gains go to owners and retraining is slow. A cashier who is replaced by a machine at fifty, for example, may find it extremely difficult to learn a new trade, so that long-term unemployment follows. Communities that depend on a single factory suffer severely, and inequality can rise if the profits are not shared. Heavy reliance on machines also makes firms vulnerable to technical failures and cyberattacks. Nevertheless, these problems can be reduced by retraining schemes, support for displaced workers and gradual introduction of new systems.

In conclusion, automation brings substantial gains in productivity and safety, but it must be managed carefully. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the disadvantages, provided that governments and employers support those who lose their jobs.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Self-service tills, robot arms and automated warehouses** — quầy tự thanh toán, cánh tay robot và kho tự động
- **work automation** — tự động hoá công việc
- **raises efficiency and safety** — nâng cao hiệu quả và an toàn
- **make fewer errors** — mắc ít lỗi hơn
- **take over dangerous tasks** — đảm nhận các công việc nguy hiểm
- **weld and paint** — hàn và sơn
- **vehicles of consistent quality** — phương tiện có chất lượng đồng đều
- **fumes and heavy lifting** — khói và việc nâng vác nặng
- **work day and night without rest** — làm việc ngày đêm không nghỉ
- **lowers costs and prices for consumers** — giảm chi phí và giá cho người tiêu dùng
- **design, supervision and customer care** — thiết kế, giám sát và chăm sóc khách hàng
- **fatal to people** — gây chết người
- **threatens jobs** — đe doạ việc làm
- **Workers in routine roles** — người lao động ở vai trò lặp lại
- **gains go to owners** — lợi ích thuộc về chủ sở hữu
- **retraining** — đào tạo lại
- **learn a new trade** — học một nghề mới
- **long-term unemployment** — thất nghiệp dài hạn
- **depend on a single factory** — phụ thuộc vào một nhà máy
- **vulnerable** — dễ bị tổn thương
- **technical failures and cyberattacks** — lỗi kỹ thuật và tấn công mạng
- **retraining schemes** — chương trình đào tạo lại
- **displaced workers** — người lao động bị mất việc

#259 Advantages / Disadvantages · 273 từ · AI 7.5

Do the advantages of a shorter workweek outweigh the disadvantages? Give reasons and examples.

Several companies and a few governments have tested a four-day working week, and the question is whether the advantages of a shorter workweek outweigh the disadvantages. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, a shorter workweek improves wellbeing and often keeps output steady. Employees with an extra day off are rested and focused and are less likely to quit. A software firm that moves to four days, for example, may find that staff complete the same work in less time because meetings are shorter and distractions are reduced. Workers gain time for family, exercise and study, which lowers stress and illness. Employers benefit from fewer sick days, lower turnover and a stronger ability to attract talent, and a shorter week may even cut energy use in offices and reduce commuting.

On the negative side, a shorter workweek is not suitable for every sector. Hospitals, shops and factories need cover, so more staff may be required, which raises costs. Some firms may struggle with deadlines, and employees may be pressed to complete the same duties in longer days, which can be tiring. A nurse who works twelve-hour shifts to fit a compressed week, for example, may suffer from fatigue. Customers may also receive slower service if businesses are closed for an extra day. Nevertheless, these problems can be reduced by careful scheduling, by reducing hours instead of compressing them and by testing the change first.

In conclusion, a shorter workweek has clear benefits for wellbeing and productivity. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the disadvantages, especially in office jobs where results can be measured.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a four-day working week** — tuần làm việc bốn ngày
- **a shorter workweek** — tuần làm việc ngắn hơn
- **improves wellbeing and often keeps output steady** — cải thiện sức khoẻ tinh thần và thường giữ sản lượng ổn định
- **an extra day off** — thêm một ngày nghỉ
- **rested and focused** — được nghỉ ngơi và tập trung
- **less likely to quit** — ít có khả năng nghỉ việc
- **complete the same work in less time** — hoàn thành cùng khối lượng việc trong ít thời gian hơn
- **meetings are shorter and distractions are reduced** — họp ngắn hơn và ít xao nhãng hơn
- **time for family, exercise and study** — thời gian cho gia đình, thể dục và học tập
- **fewer sick days, lower turnover** — ít ngày ốm hơn, tỷ lệ nghỉ việc thấp hơn
- **attract talent** — thu hút nhân tài
- **cut energy use in offices** — giảm sử dụng năng lượng trong văn phòng
- **not suitable for every sector** — không phù hợp với mọi lĩnh vực
- **need cover** — cần có người thay
- **struggle with deadlines** — gặp khó khăn với thời hạn
- **twelve-hour shifts** — ca làm việc mười hai giờ
- **a compressed week** — tuần làm việc nén
- **careful scheduling** — lập lịch cẩn thận
- **reducing hours instead of compressing them** — giảm số giờ thay vì nén chúng
- **clear benefits** — lợi ích rõ ràng

#430 Advantages / Disadvantages · 269 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of telecommuting for employers.

Many firms now allow staff to work from home several days a week, and this essay will discuss the advantages and disadvantages of telecommuting for employers before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, telecommuting saves employers money. Firms need less office space and can hire from anywhere. A company that allows half of its staff to work remotely, for example, can move into a smaller building and save a large amount on rent, electricity and cleaning. It can also recruit talented workers who live far away or who cannot commute because of disability or family duties, and it can keep experienced staff who might otherwise leave. Many employers report that remote staff are happier and take fewer sick days, which improves output. In addition, businesses can continue operating during storms, strikes or epidemics.

On the negative side, telecommuting makes management and security harder. Supervising staff, building culture and protecting data are more difficult when people work in different places. A manager who cannot see his team may not notice that a new employee is struggling, and sensitive information may be stored on unsafe home networks. Spontaneous conversations that produce ideas are less frequent, and new staff learn the company culture more slowly. Some employees may also take advantage of the freedom by working less. Nevertheless, employers can reduce these risks by setting clear goals, measuring results instead of hours, providing secure systems and requiring regular meetings.

In conclusion, telecommuting offers employers significant savings and a wider pool of talent. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the disadvantages, provided that firms invest in management and security.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **work from home several days a week** — làm việc tại nhà vài ngày mỗi tuần
- **telecommuting** — làm việc từ xa
- **saves employers money** — giúp nhà tuyển dụng tiết kiệm tiền
- **less office space** — ít không gian văn phòng hơn
- **hire from anywhere** — tuyển dụng từ bất kỳ đâu
- **rent, electricity and cleaning** — tiền thuê, điện và dọn dẹp
- **cannot commute because of disability or family duties** — không thể đi lại vì khuyết tật hoặc bổn phận gia đình
- **keep experienced staff** — giữ chân nhân viên có kinh nghiệm
- **take fewer sick days** — nghỉ ốm ít hơn
- **storms, strikes or epidemics** — bão, đình công hoặc dịch bệnh
- **Supervising staff, building culture and protecting data** — giám sát nhân viên, xây dựng văn hoá và bảo vệ dữ liệu
- **a new employee is struggling** — nhân viên mới đang gặp khó khăn
- **unsafe home networks** — mạng gia đình không an toàn
- **Spontaneous conversations** — những cuộc trò chuyện ngẫu hứng
- **take advantage of the freedom** — lợi dụng sự tự do
- **setting clear goals** — đặt mục tiêu rõ ràng
- **measuring results instead of hours** — đo lường kết quả thay vì số giờ
- **secure systems** — hệ thống an toàn
- **a wider pool of talent** — nguồn nhân tài rộng hơn

#481 Advantages / Disadvantages · 282 từ · AI 7.0

Do the advantages of higher retirement ages outweigh the social costs? Give reasons and examples.

As people live longer, many governments are raising the age at which citizens can receive a state pension, and the question is whether the advantages of higher retirement ages outweigh the social costs. This essay will discuss both sides before explaining my own view.

On the positive side, higher retirement ages ease pension costs. People live longer, so working later keeps pension funds solvent and experience in the workforce. When life expectancy rises by several years, paying pensions from sixty for thirty years becomes unaffordable. A country that raises the age from sixty-two to sixty-seven, for example, may avoid large tax increases or cuts in other services such as health and education. Many older people are healthy and wish to remain active, and employers benefit from their skills and reliability. Longer careers also give workers more time to save for their own retirement.

On the negative side, higher retirement ages impose social costs on some workers. Manual workers and those in poor health struggle, and young jobseekers may find fewer openings. A builder of sixty-six, for example, may be physically unable to continue, yet he cannot claim a full pension. Life expectancy differs between rich and poor, so that people on low incomes enjoy fewer years of retirement. Some older workers also face age discrimination and find it hard to keep jobs. Nevertheless, these costs can be reduced by exemptions for heavy occupations, phased retirement, retraining for older staff and laws against age discrimination.

In conclusion, higher retirement ages bring financial benefits but impose real burdens on some groups. On balance, I believe that the advantages outweigh the costs, provided that flexibility and support are offered to those who cannot work longer.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **live longer** — sống lâu hơn
- **raising the age at which citizens can receive a state pension** — nâng độ tuổi công dân được nhận lương hưu nhà nước
- **higher retirement ages** — tuổi nghỉ hưu cao hơn
- **social costs** — chi phí xã hội
- **ease pension costs** — giảm bớt chi phí lương hưu
- **keeps pension funds solvent** — giữ cho quỹ hưu trí có khả năng chi trả
- **life expectancy rises** — tuổi thọ tăng
- **unaffordable** — không đủ khả năng chi trả
- **avoid large tax increases** — tránh tăng thuế lớn
- **cuts in other services** — cắt giảm các dịch vụ khác
- **remain active** — vẫn năng động
- **skills and reliability** — kỹ năng và sự đáng tin cậy
- **Longer careers** — sự nghiệp dài hơn
- **Manual workers and those in poor health struggle** — lao động chân tay và người sức khoẻ yếu gặp khó khăn
- **fewer openings** — ít vị trí hơn
- **claim a full pension** — nhận đủ lương hưu
- **on low incomes** — có thu nhập thấp
- **fewer years of retirement** — ít năm nghỉ hưu hơn
- **Older workers** — người lao động lớn tuổi
- **age discrimination** — phân biệt tuổi tác
- **exemptions for heavy occupations** — miễn trừ cho các nghề nặng nhọc
- **phased retirement** — nghỉ hưu theo từng giai đoạn
- **retraining** — đào tạo lại
- **outweigh the costs** — lớn hơn chi phí

Extent

#53 Extent · 268 từ · AI 7.5

How far do you think artificial intelligence will change the workplace in the next 20 years? Support your answer with reasons.

Software that writes reports, answers customers and reads medical scans is already in use, and the question is how far artificial intelligence will change the workplace within twenty years. I believe that it will change many tasks greatly, although it will not replace human work entirely.

To begin with, artificial intelligence will change the nature of many jobs. It automates routine and data-heavy tasks, such as sorting documents, scheduling and basic analysis, and it creates new roles in design, supervision and maintenance. An accountant whose software prepares routine accounts, for example, can spend more time advising clients on tax and strategy. Factories, offices and shops will all use intelligent systems to cut costs and errors, and workers who learn to use these tools will become much more productive. Companies that adopt them early are likely to gain a competitive advantage.

However, the workplace will be reshaped rather than emptied. Jobs that need creativity, judgement and personal care, such as teaching, nursing and counselling, remain human, because people value empathy and trust. At the same time, some workers will lose their positions, particularly in clerical and routine roles, and they must be retrained as roles change. Governments and employers therefore need to support lifelong learning and to protect those who are displaced. Past technologies, from the steam engine to the computer, destroyed some jobs but created many others, and there is little reason to expect that this pattern will end now.

In conclusion, artificial intelligence will change the workplace to a very large extent over the next twenty years, but it will reshape human work rather than replace it.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **writes reports, answers customers and reads medical scans** — viết báo cáo, trả lời khách hàng và đọc ảnh chụp y tế
- **artificial intelligence** — trí tuệ nhân tạo
- **change the workplace** — thay đổi nơi làm việc
- **routine and data-heavy tasks** — công việc lặp lại và nhiều dữ liệu
- **sorting documents, scheduling and basic analysis** — sắp xếp tài liệu, lên lịch và phân tích cơ bản
- **design, supervision and maintenance** — thiết kế, giám sát và bảo trì
- **prepares routine accounts** — lập sổ sách thường kỳ
- **advising clients on tax and strategy** — tư vấn khách hàng về thuế và chiến lược
- **cut costs and errors** — cắt giảm chi phí và sai sót
- **a competitive advantage** — lợi thế cạnh tranh
- **reshaped rather than emptied** — được định hình lại chứ không bị làm trống
- **creativity, judgement and personal care** — sự sáng tạo, phán đoán và chăm sóc cá nhân
- **empathy and trust** — sự đồng cảm và niềm tin
- **at the same time** — đồng thời
- **clerical and routine roles** — vai trò văn thư và công việc lặp lại
- **retrained** — được đào tạo lại
- **lifelong learning** — học tập suốt đời
- **displaced** — bị mất việc
- **from the steam engine to the computer** — từ động cơ hơi nước đến máy tính

#140 Extent · 271 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent should employers provide training for new workers? Give reasons for your answer.

Many companies hire graduates and expect them to start work immediately, and the question is to what extent employers should provide training for new workers. I agree to a large extent, because training makes workers productive and loyal, although the cost may be shared.

To begin with, employers should train new workers because it makes them productive and loyal. Schools and universities cannot teach every company procedure, so training reduces mistakes and raises confidence. A new technician who receives a month of guidance on the company's machines, for example, will work safely and quickly instead of learning through costly errors. Training also tells employees that the company values them, and staff who feel invested in stay longer. Since recruiting and replacing workers is expensive, the cost of training is often smaller than the cost of high turnover. Well-trained staff also serve customers better, which improves the company's reputation.

However, there are limits to the responsibility of employers. Small firms may lack the money and time to organise formal programmes, and some employers worry that trained workers will leave for competitors. Governments can help by offering subsidies or tax benefits for training, and schools should teach general skills such as communication and problem solving so that employers need to provide only specific instruction. Workers should also take their own initiative by learning outside work. Where contracts include a fair period of service after expensive courses, both sides can be protected.

In conclusion, I agree that employers should provide training for new workers to a large extent, since it is an investment that repays itself, but governments and schools should share the burden.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **hire graduates and expect them to start work immediately** — thuê sinh viên mới ra trường và mong họ làm việc ngay
- **provide training for new workers** — đào tạo nhân viên mới
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **productive and loyal** — năng suất và trung thành
- **every company procedure** — mọi quy trình của công ty
- **reduces mistakes and raises confidence** — giảm sai sót và tăng sự tự tin
- **a month of guidance** — một tháng hướng dẫn
- **costly errors** — những sai lầm tốn kém
- **values them** — coi trọng họ
- **feel invested in** — cảm thấy được đầu tư
- **recruiting and replacing workers is expensive** — tuyển và thay nhân viên rất tốn kém
- **high turnover** — tỷ lệ nghỉ việc cao
- **serve customers better** — phục vụ khách hàng tốt hơn
- **lack the money and time** — thiếu tiền bạc và thời gian
- **organise** — tổ chức
- **formal programmes** — chương trình chính quy
- **leave for competitors** — chuyển sang đối thủ
- **subsidies or tax benefits** — trợ cấp hoặc ưu đãi thuế
- **communication and problem solving** — giao tiếp và giải quyết vấn đề
- **take their own initiative** — tự chủ động
- **a fair period of service** — khoảng thời gian phục vụ hợp lý
- **an investment that repays itself** — khoản đầu tư tự hoàn vốn

#170 Extent · 279 từ · AI 7.5

Some argue that stricter immigration controls protect jobs. To what extent do you agree?

In many countries, politicians promise to cut immigration in order to defend local workers, and some argue that stricter immigration controls protect jobs. I agree only to a limited extent, since limits may protect some local jobs but can harm the economy as a whole.

To begin with, controls may help certain groups in the short term. Limits can reduce competition for low-skilled work, and they may prevent employers from using cheaper foreign labour to push down wages. A local builder who loses contracts to a lower-paid foreign crew, for example, may feel that rules would safeguard his income. In regions with high unemployment, people understandably want newcomers to be limited until jobs are available, and enforcement of existing laws can stop illegal employment that undermines fair conditions.

However, strict controls can harm the economy in the longer term. Migrants fill shortages in health, farming and technology, spend money and create businesses that employ locals. Hospitals in many countries depend on foreign doctors and nurses, and farms may leave crops unpicked without seasonal workers. Immigrants also pay taxes that support public services for ageing populations. Research generally finds that the effect of immigration on local wages and jobs is small, and that unemployment is caused more by recessions and automation than by newcomers. Targeted rules, such as those that match visas to genuine shortages and enforce labour standards, work better than strict bans. Countries that combine controlled migration with strong training for local workers usually see the best results for employment.

In conclusion, stricter immigration controls protect jobs only to a limited extent, and policies should be selective instead of restrictive so that both workers and the economy benefit.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **cut immigration in order to defend local workers** — cắt giảm nhập cư để bảo vệ người lao động địa phương
- **stricter immigration controls** — kiểm soát nhập cư chặt chẽ hơn
- **protect jobs** — bảo vệ việc làm
- **to a limited extent** — ở mức độ hạn chế
- **reduce competition for low-skilled work** — giảm cạnh tranh việc làm kỹ năng thấp
- **cheaper foreign labour** — lao động nước ngoài rẻ hơn
- **push down wages** — đẩy mức lương xuống
- **a lower-paid foreign crew** — nhóm lao động nước ngoài trả lương thấp hơn
- **high unemployment** — tỷ lệ thất nghiệp cao
- **illegal employment** — việc làm bất hợp pháp
- **undermines fair conditions** — làm suy yếu điều kiện công bằng
- **Migrants fill shortages in health, farming and technology** — người nhập cư lấp chỗ thiếu hụt trong y tế, nông nghiệp và công nghệ
- **create businesses that employ locals** — lập doanh nghiệp thuê người địa phương
- **foreign doctors and nurses** — bác sĩ và y tá nước ngoài
- **seasonal workers** — lao động thời vụ
- **pay taxes that support public services** — đóng thuế hỗ trợ dịch vụ công
- **Ageing populations** — dân số già hoá
- **recessions and automation** — suy thoái và tự động hoá
- **match visas to genuine shortages** — gắn thị thực với thiếu hụt thực sự
- **controlled** — được kiểm soát
- **selective instead of restrictive** — chọn lọc thay vì hạn chế

#382 Extent · 272 từ · AI 7.5

To what extent should employees be allowed to unionize? Give reasons for your answer.

Workers in many industries belong to unions, while in others employers discourage them, and the question is to what extent employees should be allowed to unionise. I agree to a large extent, because collective bargaining protects fair pay and safety, although unions must act responsibly.

To begin with, employees should be allowed to unionise because individuals have little power against large employers. Unions negotiate wages, working conditions and protection from unfair dismissal. A group of warehouse workers who complain about unsafe equipment, for example, is much more likely to be heard through a union than if each of them speaks alone and risks dismissal. Many improvements that people now take for granted, such as limits on working hours, paid holidays and safety rules, were won through union campaigns. Freedom to organise is also recognised as a basic right in international agreements, and it allows workers to take part in decisions that shape their lives.

However, rights should come with responsible use. Strikes can disrupt hospitals, transport and schools, harming people who are not part of the dispute, and rigid rules negotiated by powerful unions may slow change or protect weaker workers at the expense of newcomers. Some countries therefore require notice and a vote before industrial action, and keep essential services running. Employers also need the ability to adapt to competition. A system in which negotiations are open and both sides are ready to compromise generally produces better results for companies and employees alike.

In conclusion, I agree that employees should be allowed to unionise, because it balances the power of employers, but laws should ensure that this right is used responsibly.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **belong to unions** — là thành viên công đoàn
- **unionise** — lập công đoàn
- **to a large extent** — ở mức độ lớn
- **collective bargaining** — thương lượng tập thể
- **fair pay and safety** — lương công bằng và an toàn
- **little power against large employers** — ít quyền lực trước những nhà tuyển dụng lớn
- **wages, working conditions and protection from unfair dismissal** — tiền lương, điều kiện làm việc và bảo vệ khỏi sa thải bất công
- **unsafe equipment** — thiết bị không an toàn
- **risks dismissal** — có nguy cơ bị sa thải
- **limits on working hours, paid holidays and safety rules** — giới hạn giờ làm, ngày nghỉ có lương và quy tắc an toàn
- **union campaigns** — các chiến dịch của công đoàn
- **organise** — tổ chức
- **a basic right** — một quyền cơ bản
- **international agreements** — thoả thuận quốc tế
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm
- **Strikes can disrupt hospitals, transport and schools** — đình công có thể làm gián đoạn bệnh viện, giao thông và trường học
- **rigid rules** — quy tắc cứng nhắc
- **notice and a vote before industrial action** — thông báo và bỏ phiếu trước khi đình công
- **essential services** — dịch vụ thiết yếu
- **adapt to competition** — thích nghi với cạnh tranh
- **compromise** — thoả hiệp
- **used responsibly** — được sử dụng có trách nhiệm

Discuss both views

#58 Discuss both views · 281 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer working for large corporations while others prefer small businesses. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

When choosing a career, some graduates dream of joining a famous corporation, while others prefer a small local firm, and opinions differ on which offers the better working life. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of large corporations argue that they offer security and benefits. Big companies pay well, train staff and rarely collapse, and they offer clear promotion paths and international opportunities. A young engineer who joins a global company, for example, may receive expensive training and the chance to work abroad. Large firms also provide health insurance, pensions and paid holidays, and a well-known name on a curriculum vitae opens doors later. Departments in a big firm also let staff move between roles without changing employer, which keeps careers interesting over many years. For people who value stability, particularly those with families, this is a strong argument.

On the other hand, advocates of small businesses point out that they offer variety and closer relationships. Employees can feel like small cogs in a large company, whereas small businesses give wider responsibility, faster promotion and a friendly atmosphere. A graduate in a small design studio, for example, may handle clients, budgets and creative work within a year. Decisions are made quickly, and ideas from staff are more likely to be heard. The disadvantages are lower pay, fewer benefits and less stability, since small firms can fail during a recession.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that the best choice depends on personality and career stage: a large corporation suits those who need security, while a small business suits those who want to learn quickly and to take responsibility.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a famous corporation** — một tập đoàn nổi tiếng
- **a small local firm** — một công ty nhỏ ở địa phương
- **better working life** — cuộc sống làm việc tốt hơn
- **security and benefits** — sự ổn định và phúc lợi
- **pay well, train staff and rarely collapse** — trả lương tốt, đào tạo nhân viên và hiếm khi sụp đổ
- **clear promotion paths** — lộ trình thăng tiến rõ ràng
- **international opportunities** — cơ hội quốc tế
- **expensive training and the chance to work abroad** — đào tạo tốn kém và cơ hội làm việc ở nước ngoài
- **health insurance, pensions and paid holidays** — bảo hiểm y tế, lương hưu và ngày nghỉ có lương
- **a well-known name on a curriculum vitae** — một cái tên nổi tiếng trong sơ yếu lý lịch
- **variety and closer relationships** — sự đa dạng và mối quan hệ gần gũi hơn
- **small cogs in a large company** — những bánh răng nhỏ trong một công ty lớn
- **wider responsibility, faster promotion** — trách nhiệm rộng hơn, thăng tiến nhanh hơn
- **a friendly atmosphere** — bầu không khí thân thiện
- **handle clients, budgets and creative work** — xử lý khách hàng, ngân sách và công việc sáng tạo
- **Decisions are made quickly** — quyết định được đưa ra nhanh chóng
- **lower pay, fewer benefits and less stability** — lương thấp hơn, ít phúc lợi hơn và kém ổn định hơn
- **career stage** — giai đoạn sự nghiệp

#72 Discuss both views · 269 từ · AI 7.5

Should individuals be responsible for their retirement planning, or should society/government take action? Discuss.

As populations age, the cost of pensions is rising, and opinions differ on whether individuals should be responsible for their own retirement planning or whether society and government should take action. This essay will consider both perspectives before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of personal responsibility argue that people who save early and invest wisely gain independence. Workers who put aside a small part of their income each month, for example, can build a substantial fund over forty years because of compound interest. Individuals know their own needs and plans, and personal saving encourages thrift and reduces the burden on taxpayers. Since people are living longer, governments may not be able to afford generous pensions for everyone, so that a sense of personal duty is realistic and fair to younger generations.

On the other hand, advocates of government action point out that many people cannot save enough. Low earners, carers and the self-employed often have no spare income or employer scheme, and investments can lose value just before retirement. Retirement security needs both personal saving and a public pension. The state can guarantee a basic pension, require employers to contribute and regulate financial products to protect savers. Without such measures, many elderly people would fall into poverty, which would cost society more in welfare and healthcare. Public pensions also pool risk across the whole population in a way that individuals cannot.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that retirement should be a shared responsibility, with a basic public pension and encouragement to save privately, so that everyone is protected in old age.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **As populations age** — khi dân số già đi
- **the cost of pensions is rising** — chi phí lương hưu đang tăng
- **responsible** — có trách nhiệm
- **retirement planning** — lập kế hoạch nghỉ hưu
- **supporters of personal responsibility** — người ủng hộ trách nhiệm cá nhân
- **save early and invest wisely** — tiết kiệm sớm và đầu tư khôn ngoan
- **put aside a small part of their income** — để dành một phần nhỏ thu nhập
- **a substantial fund** — một quỹ đáng kể
- **compound interest** — lãi kép
- **encourages thrift** — khuyến khích tiết kiệm
- **the burden on taxpayers** — gánh nặng cho người đóng thuế
- **generous pensions** — lương hưu hào phóng
- **Low earners, carers and the self-employed** — người thu nhập thấp, người chăm sóc và người tự kinh doanh
- **employer scheme** — chương trình của nhà tuyển dụng
- **lose value just before retirement** — mất giá ngay trước khi nghỉ hưu
- **guarantee a basic pension** — bảo đảm lương hưu cơ bản
- **regulate financial products** — quản lý các sản phẩm tài chính
- **fall into poverty** — rơi vào nghèo đói
- **pool risk** — chia sẻ rủi ro
- **a shared responsibility** — trách nhiệm chung

#98 Discuss both views · 267 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer public sector jobs while others prefer private sector jobs. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Graduates often face a choice between a post in a ministry or hospital run by the state and a job in a private company, and opinions differ on which is preferable. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of public sector jobs argue that they offer security and meaning. Government posts bring steady hours, pensions and a sense of public service. A teacher or civil servant, for example, rarely worries about being dismissed during an economic downturn and can plan a mortgage or a family with confidence. Public employers usually offer generous leave, clear rules on promotion and protection against unfair treatment, and many people feel proud to contribute directly to society. For those who value a calm routine and a good work-life balance, these features are very attractive.

On the other hand, advocates of private sector jobs point out that they reward performance. Private firms pay more, promote talented staff rapidly and encourage innovation, at the price of insecurity. A salesperson or engineer who achieves excellent results, for example, may double her salary within a few years. Competition pushes employees to learn new skills, and ambitious people are not held back by long hierarchies. However, redundancies, long hours and pressure to meet targets are more common, and benefits are often less generous than in government service.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that the choice depends on attitude to risk: people who value stability and service should seek public jobs, while those who want rapid progress and higher pay should choose the private sector.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **a post in a ministry or hospital run by the state** — vị trí trong bộ hoặc bệnh viện do nhà nước quản lý
- **a job in a private company** — công việc ở công ty tư nhân
- **public sector jobs** — công việc khu vực nhà nước
- **security and meaning** — sự ổn định và ý nghĩa
- **steady hours, pensions and a sense of public service** — giờ giấc đều đặn, lương hưu và cảm giác phục vụ cộng đồng
- **being dismissed during an economic downturn** — bị sa thải trong lúc kinh tế suy thoái
- **plan a mortgage or a family with confidence** — tự tin lên kế hoạch vay mua nhà hay lập gia đình
- **generous leave** — chế độ nghỉ phép hào phóng
- **protection against unfair treatment** — bảo vệ khỏi đối xử bất công
- **a calm routine** — nhịp sống bình lặng
- **reward performance** — thưởng cho hiệu suất
- **pay more, promote talented staff rapidly** — trả lương cao hơn, thăng chức nhanh cho nhân viên giỏi
- **encourage innovation** — khuyến khích đổi mới
- **double her salary** — tăng gấp đôi mức lương
- **Competition pushes employees to learn new skills** — cạnh tranh thúc đẩy nhân viên học kỹ năng mới
- **long hierarchies** — hệ thống thứ bậc dài
- **redundancies, long hours and pressure to meet targets** — sa thải, giờ làm dài và áp lực đạt chỉ tiêu
- **attitude to risk** — thái độ đối với rủi ro

#125 Discuss both views · 271 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that work-life balance is essential. Others think long hours show commitment. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Offices that glow late into the evening are common in many cities, and opinions differ on whether work-life balance is essential or whether long hours show commitment. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of long hours argue that they show commitment. Employees who stay late demonstrate that they care about their organisation, and managers often reward them with promotion. A junior lawyer who works through weekends before a major trial, for example, may build a reputation that helps her whole career. In competitive fields or during busy periods, extra effort can mean the difference between success and failure, and some people enjoy their work so much that long hours do not feel like a burden. Start-up founders often say that their companies could not have survived without such dedication.

On the other hand, advocates of balance point out that rest protects health and performance. Rested employees concentrate better and stay longer in a job, while those who work excessively burn out, so results matter more than hours present. Time with family, friends and hobbies is needed to recover from stress, and workers who feel respected are more loyal. A staff member who leaves at a fixed time and works efficiently, for example, may produce more than a colleague who is tired all day. Companies that ignore this risk errors, absences and a high turnover of staff.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that work-life balance is essential, and that commitment should be measured by the quality of results, although occasional extra effort in a busy period is reasonable.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Offices that glow late into the evening** — văn phòng sáng đèn đến tối muộn
- **work-life balance is essential** — cân bằng công việc – cuộc sống là thiết yếu
- **long hours show commitment** — giờ làm dài thể hiện sự cam kết
- **Employees who stay late** — nhân viên ở lại muộn
- **reward them with promotion** — thưởng cho họ bằng thăng chức
- **works through weekends** — làm việc xuyên cuối tuần
- **build a reputation** — gây dựng danh tiếng
- **the difference between success and failure** — sự khác biệt giữa thành công và thất bại
- **Start-up founders** — người sáng lập công ty khởi nghiệp
- **rest protects health and performance** — nghỉ ngơi bảo vệ sức khoẻ và hiệu suất
- **Rested employees concentrate better** — nhân viên được nghỉ ngơi tập trung tốt hơn
- **burn out** — kiệt sức
- **results matter more than hours present** — kết quả quan trọng hơn số giờ có mặt
- **recover from stress** — hồi phục sau căng thẳng
- **feel respected** — cảm thấy được tôn trọng
- **leaves at a fixed time and works efficiently** — ra về đúng giờ cố định và làm việc hiệu quả
- **all day** — cả ngày
- **a high turnover of staff** — tỷ lệ nhân viên nghỉ việc cao
- **the quality of results** — chất lượng kết quả

#138 Discuss both views · 262 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer career stability while others prefer career flexibility. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Some graduates look for a post in which they can stay for thirty years, while others change employers every few years, and opinions differ on whether career stability or career flexibility is preferable. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of stability argue that it brings security and expertise. A steady career brings regular income, deep skills and the confidence to plan. A nurse who stays in one hospital for decades, for example, becomes an expert in her field and is trusted with greater responsibility. Employees who stay can obtain loans, buy homes and plan for children with greater certainty, and employers are generally willing to invest in training for loyal staff. Long service is also rewarded with higher pay and pensions, and colleagues form strong working relationships.

On the other hand, supporters of flexibility argue that it offers adaptability and fresh opportunity. Those who change jobs learn many skills, adapt when industries decline and avoid boredom. A programmer who moves between companies, for example, gains experience with different technologies and often receives a higher salary at each move. In an economy where companies can fail suddenly and technology changes quickly, depending on a single employer is risky, and flexible workers can seize new opportunities. People who are curious also feel more satisfied when each year brings new challenges.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that a mixture suits modern life: workers should build solid core skills and a stable base, while remaining willing to change when circumstances demand it.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **stay for thirty years** — ở lại ba mươi năm
- **change employers every few years** — đổi nhà tuyển dụng vài năm một lần
- **career stability** — sự ổn định nghề nghiệp
- **career flexibility** — sự linh hoạt nghề nghiệp
- **security and expertise** — sự an toàn và chuyên môn
- **regular income, deep skills and the confidence to plan** — thu nhập đều đặn, kỹ năng sâu và sự tự tin để lên kế hoạch
- **an expert in her field** — chuyên gia trong lĩnh vực của cô
- **trusted with greater responsibility** — được tin tưởng giao trách nhiệm lớn hơn
- **obtain loans, buy homes** — vay vốn, mua nhà
- **invest in training for loyal staff** — đầu tư đào tạo cho nhân viên trung thành
- **Long service is also rewarded** — thâm niên cũng được thưởng
- **strong working relationships** — các mối quan hệ làm việc bền chặt
- **adaptability and fresh opportunity** — khả năng thích nghi và cơ hội mới
- **adapt when industries decline** — thích nghi khi ngành suy giảm
- **avoid boredom** — tránh sự nhàm chán
- **moves between companies** — chuyển giữa các công ty
- **a higher salary at each move** — mức lương cao hơn ở mỗi lần chuyển
- **depending on a single employer is risky** — phụ thuộc vào một nhà tuyển dụng duy nhất là rủi ro
- **seize new opportunities** — nắm bắt cơ hội mới
- **a stable base** — nền tảng ổn định

#158 Discuss both views · 270 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer morning work shifts while others prefer evening shifts. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Hospitals, shops and factories run all day and night, and many employees must choose their shift, so opinions differ on whether morning or evening work is better. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of morning shifts argue that they fit the body clock and family life. Most people sleep and eat better on day schedules and have evenings with family. A shop assistant who starts at seven and finishes at three, for example, can collect children from school, cook a meal and see friends in the evening. Morning workers are also usually more alert, since they have rested overnight, and public transport, banks and offices are open when they finish. Many people find that early starts give them a sense of achievement, as the most demanding tasks are completed before lunch.

On the other hand, supporters of evening shifts point out that these suit people who want free mornings and extra pay. Evening workers avoid rush-hour traffic, may earn allowances and can use the morning for study, errands or appointments. A student who works from four until midnight, for example, can attend lectures during the day and still earn a wage. Night owls often feel most energetic later in the day, so that they perform better in the evening. However, evening work reduces time with family and friends, and irregular sleep can affect health over many years.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that the choice depends on personality and responsibilities, but for most people, particularly parents, a morning shift offers a healthier and more sociable routine.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **run all day and night** — hoạt động cả ngày lẫn đêm
- **choose their shift** — chọn ca làm
- **morning shifts** — ca sáng
- **fit the body clock and family life** — phù hợp nhịp sinh học và đời sống gia đình
- **sleep and eat better on day schedules** — ngủ và ăn tốt hơn với lịch làm ban ngày
- **collect children from school** — đón trẻ từ trường
- **more alert** — tỉnh táo hơn
- **public transport** — giao thông công cộng
- **a sense of achievement** — cảm giác thành tựu
- **the most demanding tasks are completed before lunch** — những việc đòi hỏi nhất được hoàn thành trước bữa trưa
- **evening shifts** — ca tối
- **free mornings and extra pay** — buổi sáng rảnh và thêm tiền lương
- **Evening workers avoid rush-hour traffic** — nhân viên ca tối tránh giờ cao điểm
- **earn allowances** — nhận phụ cấp
- **errands or appointments** — việc vặt hoặc cuộc hẹn
- **attend lectures during the day** — dự giờ giảng ban ngày
- **Night owls** — người thức khuya
- **reduces time with family and friends** — giảm thời gian bên gia đình và bạn bè
- **irregular sleep** — giấc ngủ thất thường
- **a healthier and more sociable routine** — nhịp sống lành mạnh và hoà đồng hơn

#178 Discuss both views · 276 từ · AI 8.0

Some people prefer flexible working hours while others prefer fixed hours. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Some employees would like to arrive at ten and leave at six, while others prefer a regular nine-to-five day, and opinions differ on whether flexible or fixed working hours are better. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of flexible hours argue that they raise satisfaction. Employees who choose when to start can avoid traffic and meet family needs. A parent who starts at ten after taking children to school, for example, arrives calm and works with more concentration. People are not equally alert at the same time of day, so those who work when they feel best are more productive. Flexibility also helps people to attend appointments and to study, and companies that offer it attract talented staff and reduce absence. Such arrangements show that employers trust their staff, which strengthens loyalty.

On the other hand, supporters of fixed hours argue that they help teamwork and routine. A fixed schedule makes meetings easy, sets clear limits and gives life a predictable rhythm. A customer service team, for example, must be available during stated hours, and colleagues who work at different times may find it hard to cooperate. Some people also find that a flexible system leads to working at all hours, since the boundary between work and private life disappears. Fixed hours make it easier to plan activities and to separate work from rest. Core hours with flexibility around them combine the advantages of both approaches.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that flexible hours are preferable where the job allows them, provided that there are agreed core times for meetings and teamwork.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **arrive at ten and leave at six** — đến lúc mười giờ và rời lúc sáu giờ
- **a regular nine-to-five day** — ngày làm việc từ chín đến năm giờ đều đặn
- **flexible or fixed working hours** — giờ làm linh hoạt hay cố định
- **raise satisfaction** — nâng cao sự hài lòng
- **avoid traffic and meet family needs** — tránh tắc đường và đáp ứng nhu cầu gia đình
- **after taking children to school** — sau khi đưa con đến trường
- **more concentration** — tập trung hơn
- **not equally alert at the same time of day** — không tỉnh táo như nhau vào cùng giờ
- **attend appointments** — đi đến các cuộc hẹn
- **attract talented staff and reduce absence** — thu hút nhân tài và giảm vắng mặt
- **trust their staff** — tin tưởng nhân viên
- **help teamwork and routine** — hỗ trợ làm việc nhóm và nếp sống
- **makes meetings easy, sets clear limits** — giúp họp dễ dàng, đặt giới hạn rõ ràng
- **a predictable rhythm** — nhịp sống có thể dự đoán
- **a customer service team** — nhóm dịch vụ khách hàng
- **the boundary between work and private life disappears** — ranh giới giữa công việc và đời tư biến mất
- **Core hours** — giờ làm việc cốt lõi
- **where the job allows them** — khi công việc cho phép

#400 Discuss both views · 276 từ · AI 7.5

Some people prefer to retire early while others prefer to work longer. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Some employees count the years until they can stop work, while others plan to continue well into their seventies, and opinions differ on whether it is better to retire early or to work longer. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of early retirement argue that it offers time and health. People who stop early can enjoy hobbies and family and avoid wear and tear. A manual worker who retires at fifty-five, for example, may still be fit enough to travel, look after grandchildren and take up sport. Many jobs, particularly physical or stressful ones, damage health over decades, and leaving them early may increase life expectancy and quality of life. Early retirement also leaves vacancies for younger people, who may otherwise struggle to find work.

On the other hand, supporters of working longer point out that it gives income and purpose. Those who work longer earn more, keep active minds and reduce pressure on pension systems. A teacher who continues until seventy, for example, has a larger pension and may still enjoy contact with pupils and colleagues. Studies suggest that people who stay engaged remain mentally sharper, and employers value the experience of older staff. Since people are living longer, many need extra savings for twenty or thirty years of retirement, and governments cannot always afford early pensions for everyone.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that individuals should have choices: those in hard physical jobs should be able to retire earlier, while others who are healthy and enjoy work should be able to continue, with flexible or part-time arrangements for the transition.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **count the years until they can stop work** — đếm từng năm cho đến khi được nghỉ làm
- **well into their seventies** — đến tận tuổi bảy mươi
- **retire early or to work longer** — nghỉ hưu sớm hay làm việc lâu hơn
- **time and health** — thời gian và sức khoẻ
- **avoid wear and tear** — tránh hao mòn
- **retires at fifty-five** — nghỉ hưu ở tuổi năm mươi lăm
- **look after grandchildren** — trông cháu
- **physical or stressful ones** — những việc nặng nhọc hoặc căng thẳng
- **damage health** — gây hại sức khoẻ
- **life expectancy and quality of life** — tuổi thọ và chất lượng cuộc sống
- **leaves vacancies for younger people** — để lại vị trí trống cho người trẻ
- **income and purpose** — thu nhập và mục đích sống
- **keep active minds** — giữ trí óc hoạt động
- **reduce pressure on pension systems** — giảm áp lực lên hệ thống lương hưu
- **a larger pension** — khoản lương hưu lớn hơn
- **contact with pupils and colleagues** — tiếp xúc với học sinh và đồng nghiệp
- **mentally sharper** — sắc bén hơn về trí tuệ
- **the experience of older staff** — kinh nghiệm của nhân viên lớn tuổi
- **extra savings** — khoản tiết kiệm thêm
- **flexible or part-time arrangements** — sắp xếp linh hoạt hoặc bán thời gian

#496 Discuss both views · 275 từ · AI 7.5

Some people believe that remote work increases productivity and job satisfaction. Others think it harms companies and teamwork. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Since remote work became common, managers and employees have argued about its effects, and opinions differ on whether it increases productivity and job satisfaction or harms companies and teamwork. This essay will consider both views before explaining my own opinion.

On the one hand, supporters of remote work argue that it raises satisfaction and output. Staff concentrate better and value flexibility, because they avoid commuting and can organise their day around their natural rhythm. A software developer who works from a quiet room, for example, may complete in three hours a task that took six in a noisy office. Surveys show that many employees would accept a lower salary to keep this freedom, and companies that offer it find it easier to recruit and keep talent. Savings on travel also reduce stress and give workers more time to rest, which benefits their performance.

On the other hand, critics argue that remote work weakens company culture and teamwork. Chance conversations, mentoring and creative collaboration decline when people rarely meet. New employees may feel unconnected and learn more slowly, and managers find it harder to notice problems. A design team that meets only through video calls, for example, may produce fewer new ideas than one that sketches together at a whiteboard. Over time, loyalty to the company can fall, and employees may be overlooked for promotion. Hybrid models, in which staff come to the office for part of the week, combine the strengths of both.

In conclusion, both views have merit. Overall, I believe that remote work raises individual productivity and satisfaction, but companies need regular face-to-face contact to protect teamwork, so a hybrid approach is best.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **argued about its effects** — tranh luận về tác động của nó
- **increases productivity and job satisfaction** — tăng năng suất và sự hài lòng trong công việc
- **harms companies and teamwork** — gây hại cho công ty và làm việc nhóm
- **raises satisfaction and output** — nâng cao sự hài lòng và sản lượng
- **concentrate better and value flexibility** — tập trung tốt hơn và coi trọng sự linh hoạt
- **organise their day around their natural rhythm** — sắp xếp ngày theo nhịp tự nhiên của họ
- **works from a quiet room** — làm việc từ một căn phòng yên tĩnh
- **a noisy office** — văn phòng ồn ào
- **accept a lower salary** — chấp nhận mức lương thấp hơn
- **recruit and keep talent** — tuyển và giữ nhân tài
- **reduce stress** — giảm căng thẳng
- **time to rest** — thời gian nghỉ ngơi
- **weakens company culture and teamwork** — làm yếu văn hoá công ty và tinh thần đồng đội
- **Chance conversations, mentoring and creative collaboration** — trò chuyện ngẫu nhiên, cố vấn và hợp tác sáng tạo
- **feel unconnected** — cảm thấy tách biệt
- **notice problems** — nhận ra vấn đề
- **a whiteboard** — bảng trắng
- **loyalty to the company can fall** — lòng trung thành với công ty có thể giảm
- **overlooked for promotion** — bị bỏ qua khi thăng chức
- **Hybrid models** — mô hình kết hợp
- **regular face-to-face contact** — tiếp xúc trực tiếp thường xuyên

Opinion

#116 Opinion · 268 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss how the gig economy affects job security.

Apps now connect drivers, couriers and cleaners with customers within minutes, and this essay will discuss how the gig economy affects job security, focusing on the lack of contracts and on possible protection.

To begin with, the gig economy weakens job security by replacing contracts with short tasks. Platforms offer quick access to work, yet drivers and couriers have no sick pay or guaranteed hours, can be removed by an algorithm and bear all costs themselves. A delivery rider who is injured, for example, loses income immediately and may receive no compensation. Workers pay for their own vehicles, fuel and insurance, and a sudden change in the platform's rules can cut earnings overnight. Because they are classed as independent contractors, they often cannot join unions or claim unemployment benefits. Many therefore work very long hours to earn a living wage, and the lack of regular income makes it hard to rent a home or to plan for the future.

Furthermore, the gig economy does offer some advantages. It provides flexible income for students and people between jobs, and an easy way into the labour market for those without qualifications. However, these benefits do not remove the need for protection. Regulation should give gig workers basic rights, including a minimum rate of pay, insurance against accidents, clear explanations when accounts are closed and the right to appeal. Some countries have already ruled that certain platform workers are employees. With such rules, the gig economy could offer flexibility without sacrificing security.

In conclusion, the gig economy weakens job security for many workers, so governments should introduce regulation that protects them.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **connect drivers, couriers and cleaners with customers** — kết nối tài xế, người giao hàng và người dọn dẹp với khách hàng
- **the gig economy** — nền kinh tế việc làm tự do theo nền tảng
- **affects job security** — ảnh hưởng đến sự ổn định việc làm
- **replacing contracts with short tasks** — thay hợp đồng bằng các nhiệm vụ ngắn
- **no sick pay or guaranteed hours** — không có tiền ốm hay giờ làm được bảo đảm
- **removed by an algorithm** — bị loại bỏ bởi thuật toán
- **bear all costs themselves** — tự chịu mọi chi phí
- **a delivery rider** — một người giao hàng
- **loses income immediately** — mất thu nhập ngay lập tức
- **vehicles, fuel and insurance** — phương tiện, nhiên liệu và bảo hiểm
- **cut earnings overnight** — cắt giảm thu nhập chỉ sau một đêm
- **independent contractors** — nhà thầu độc lập
- **unemployment benefits** — trợ cấp thất nghiệp
- **a living wage** — mức lương đủ sống
- **flexible income** — thu nhập linh hoạt
- **an easy way into the labour market** — con đường dễ dàng vào thị trường lao động
- **a minimum rate of pay** — mức lương tối thiểu
- **the right to appeal** — quyền khiếu nại
- **flexibility without sacrificing security** — sự linh hoạt mà không hy sinh an toàn

#294 Opinion · 265 từ · AI 7.5

Discuss the role of technology in reducing unemployment.

Every new technology provokes the fear that it will destroy jobs, and this essay will discuss the role of technology in reducing unemployment, focusing on new industries and on better matching between workers and employers.

To begin with, technology destroys some jobs but creates others. New technologies create businesses and roles that did not exist before. Two decades ago, there were no app developers, social media managers or drone operators, yet today these are common careers. A town that builds a data centre, for example, needs engineers, electricians and security staff, and it also supports restaurants and shops nearby. Online shopping has reduced the number of sales assistants but created work in logistics, packaging and delivery. Technology also enables people to start small businesses from home, since a laptop and an internet connection give access to customers worldwide.

Furthermore, technology can reduce unemployment by improving the way that workers find jobs and skills. Job websites connect workers with employers, online courses teach skills cheaply and platforms allow people in remote areas to work for companies in cities. A jobseeker in a small town, for example, can learn coding through free lessons and apply for positions anywhere. However, the effect is not automatic. Workers whose jobs disappear need training and support, and governments should ensure that education and benefits keep pace with change. When these conditions are met, technology reduces unemployment over time and raises living standards.

In conclusion, technology can reduce unemployment by creating new industries and by helping workers to find jobs and learn skills, but its benefits depend on training and sensible policy.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **destroy jobs** — phá huỷ việc làm
- **reducing unemployment** — giảm thất nghiệp
- **new industries** — ngành công nghiệp mới
- **better matching between workers and employers** — sự kết nối tốt hơn giữa người lao động và nhà tuyển dụng
- **destroys some jobs but creates others** — phá huỷ một số việc làm nhưng tạo ra việc khác
- **app developers, social media managers or drone operators** — nhà phát triển ứng dụng, quản lý mạng xã hội hoặc người điều khiển drone
- **builds a data centre** — xây dựng một trung tâm dữ liệu
- **engineers, electricians and security staff** — kỹ sư, thợ điện và nhân viên bảo vệ
- **logistics, packaging and delivery** — hậu cần, đóng gói và giao hàng
- **start small businesses from home** — khởi nghiệp nhỏ tại nhà
- **customers worldwide** — khách hàng trên toàn thế giới
- **Job websites connect workers with employers** — trang web việc làm kết nối người lao động với nhà tuyển dụng
- **online courses teach skills cheaply** — khoá học trực tuyến dạy kỹ năng với chi phí thấp
- **remote areas** — vùng xa xôi
- **learn coding through free lessons** — học lập trình qua bài học miễn phí
- **not automatic** — không tự động
- **disappear** — biến mất
- **keep pace with change** — theo kịp sự thay đổi
- **raises living standards** — nâng cao mức sống

#318 Opinion · 264 từ · AI 7.0

Discuss how international trade affects domestic employment.

Goods made in distant countries fill shops everywhere, and this essay will discuss how international trade affects domestic employment, focusing on the jobs that it creates and the jobs that it destroys.

To begin with, trade creates jobs in some sectors. Export industries hire more people and imports cut prices. A car maker that sells vehicles abroad, for example, employs thousands of workers in factories and in the businesses that supply it with parts. Ports, shipping firms and warehouses depend directly on trade, and lower prices for imported goods leave consumers with more money to spend on local services. Open markets also give companies access to cheaper materials and new technology, which helps them to compete and to expand. Countries that trade widely often enjoy faster growth and higher wages overall.

On the other hand, trade destroys jobs in sectors that cannot compete. Factories that cannot compete close, leaving local workers unemployed unless they receive retraining and support. A textile town that faces cheap imports, for example, may lose most of its mills within a few years, and older workers there find it hard to start again. Companies may also move production abroad to save wages. The gains of trade are real but unevenly shared, since consumers and exporters benefit while workers in declining industries pay the price. Governments should therefore use some of the gains to finance training, regional investment and temporary support for those who lose their jobs.

In conclusion, international trade increases total employment opportunities, but it harms specific groups of workers, and fair policies are needed to help them adjust.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **Goods made in distant countries** — hàng hoá sản xuất ở các nước xa xôi
- **international trade** — thương mại quốc tế
- **domestic employment** — việc làm trong nước
- **Export industries hire more people** — ngành xuất khẩu thuê thêm người
- **imports cut prices** — hàng nhập khẩu làm giảm giá
- **sells vehicles abroad** — bán xe ra nước ngoài
- **supply it with parts** — cung cấp linh kiện cho nó
- **Ports, shipping firms and warehouses** — cảng, hãng vận tải biển và kho bãi
- **more money to spend on local services** — nhiều tiền hơn để chi tiêu cho dịch vụ địa phương
- **cheaper materials and new technology** — vật liệu rẻ hơn và công nghệ mới
- **faster growth and higher wages** — tăng trưởng nhanh hơn và lương cao hơn
- **cannot compete close** — không thể cạnh tranh và phải đóng cửa
- **leaving local workers unemployed** — khiến người lao động địa phương thất nghiệp
- **retraining and support** — đào tạo lại và hỗ trợ
- **a textile town** — một thị trấn dệt may
- **cheap imports** — hàng nhập khẩu giá rẻ
- **Older workers** — người lao động lớn tuổi
- **move production abroad to save wages** — chuyển sản xuất ra nước ngoài để tiết kiệm tiền lương
- **unevenly shared** — chia sẻ không đồng đều
- **workers in declining industries** — công nhân trong các ngành suy giảm
- **regional investment** — đầu tư khu vực
- **temporary support** — hỗ trợ tạm thời

Causes / Solutions

#364 Causes / Solutions · 263 từ · AI 7.0

How can governments better support start-ups? Suggest practical measures.

New companies create jobs and ideas, but many fail in the first years, and this essay will suggest practical measures that governments could take to support start-ups, focusing on finance and on simpler rules and advice.

To begin with, governments should help start-ups to obtain money. New firms struggle to get loans and to cope with paperwork, so grants, tax relief, one-stop registration and incubators with mentors give them time to grow. A young entrepreneur who has a good idea but no property, for example, cannot offer a bank any security, so a government guarantee scheme can make a loan possible. Public funds can invest in early-stage businesses that private investors consider too risky, and tax breaks for the first few years leave founders with more money to spend on staff and equipment. Competitions with cash prizes can also reward promising ideas.

In addition, authorities should reduce bureaucracy and provide advice. Registering a company online in one day, with a single office handling licences and taxes, saves both time and money. Incubators and science parks offer cheap office space, expert mentors and contacts with investors, and links with universities allow start-ups to use laboratories and to recruit graduates. Training in accounting, marketing and management helps founders to avoid common mistakes. Equally important, bankruptcy laws should not punish failure too harshly, so that entrepreneurs can try again. Successful start-ups create jobs and innovation, which repays the public money within a few years.

In conclusion, access to finance, simpler rules and practical advice offer the most realistic way for governments to help start-ups to grow.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **New companies create jobs and ideas** — công ty mới tạo ra việc làm và ý tưởng
- **practical measures** — biện pháp thiết thực
- **support start-ups** — hỗ trợ các công ty khởi nghiệp
- **obtain money** — có được vốn
- **get loans and to cope with paperwork** — vay vốn và đối phó với giấy tờ
- **grants, tax relief, one-stop registration** — trợ cấp, giảm thuế, đăng ký một cửa
- **incubators with mentors** — vườn ươm có cố vấn
- **a good idea but no property** — có ý tưởng hay nhưng không có tài sản
- **a government guarantee scheme** — chương trình bảo lãnh của chính phủ
- **early-stage businesses** — doanh nghiệp giai đoạn đầu
- **private investors consider too risky** — nhà đầu tư tư nhân cho là quá rủi ro
- **tax breaks for the first few years** — ưu đãi thuế trong vài năm đầu
- **cash prizes** — giải thưởng tiền mặt
- **reduce bureaucracy** — giảm thủ tục hành chính
- **Registering a company online in one day** — đăng ký công ty trực tuyến trong một ngày
- **licences** — giấy phép
- **cheap office space, expert mentors and contacts with investors** — văn phòng giá rẻ, cố vấn chuyên gia và mối liên hệ với nhà đầu tư
- **recruit graduates** — tuyển sinh viên mới tốt nghiệp
- **accounting, marketing and management** — kế toán, marketing và quản lý
- **bankruptcy laws** — luật phá sản
- **punish failure too harshly** — trừng phạt thất bại quá khắc nghiệt
- **repays the public money** — hoàn lại tiền công

#431 Causes / Solutions · 274 từ · AI 7.0

What are the causes of youth unemployment in some countries? What solutions can be proposed?

In several countries, a large proportion of people under twenty-five cannot find work, and this essay will discuss the causes of youth unemployment and suggest solutions, focusing on inexperience and mismatched skills.

To begin with, there are several reasons why young people struggle to find jobs. Employers prefer experienced applicants, courses do not always teach needed skills and recessions hit new entrants first. A graduate who applies for an office job, for example, is often told that two years of experience is required, which she cannot have without a first job. Some university subjects have little demand in the labour market, while sectors that lack workers, such as technical trades, are unpopular. Young people are also usually the first to be dismissed in a downturn, because firms find it cheaper to let them go, and many jobs open to them are temporary.

In terms of solutions, apprenticeships, wage subsidies and cooperation between schools and firms can help. Apprenticeships combine paid work with study, so that young people gain experience while they learn. A company that receives a grant for hiring a school leaver, for example, takes less risk when employing someone untested. Schools and universities should consult employers about the skills needed, and career advice should explain which fields offer jobs. Governments can also support start-ups led by young people, and offer mobility grants for those who must move to find work. Such measures give young people a first step into work, which reduces long-term damage to their careers and to the economy.

In conclusion, youth unemployment results from inexperience and mismatched skills, and it can be reduced through training and links with employers.

Cụm cần nhớ

- **under twenty-five cannot find work** — dưới hai mươi lăm tuổi không tìm được việc
- **youth unemployment** — thất nghiệp thanh niên
- **inexperience and mismatched skills** — thiếu kinh nghiệm và kỹ năng không khớp
- **struggle to find jobs** — chật vật tìm việc
- **Employers prefer experienced applicants** — nhà tuyển dụng thích ứng viên có kinh nghiệm
- **courses do not always teach needed skills** — khoá học không phải lúc nào cũng dạy kỹ năng cần thiết
- **recessions hit new entrants first** — suy thoái tác động người mới vào trước
- **two years of experience is required** — yêu cầu hai năm kinh nghiệm
- **little demand in the labour market** — ít nhu cầu trên thị trường lao động
- **technical trades** — các nghề kỹ thuật
- **first to be dismissed** — bị sa thải đầu tiên
- **temporary** — tạm thời
- **Apprenticeships** — học nghề
- **wage subsidies** — trợ cấp tiền lương
- **cooperation between schools and firms** — hợp tác giữa trường học và công ty
- **a grant for hiring a school leaver** — khoản trợ cấp khi thuê học sinh mới ra trường
- **career advice** — tư vấn nghề nghiệp
- **support start-ups** — hỗ trợ các công ty khởi nghiệp
- **mobility grants** — trợ cấp di chuyển
- **a first step into work** — bước đầu tiên vào thế giới việc làm